

Evacuating with pets

EVACUATION SHELTER / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Take pets when you can evacuate safely, using a carrier or lead and a destination that accepts them. Keep food, water, medicines, identification and veterinary information together. Do not delay escape into immediate danger or reenter a hazardous building for an animal.

Do now.

**Contain animals early**

01

Use a secure carrier or lead before loading or opening doors. Distress and noise can cause animals to run.

**Confirm the destination**

02

Ask whether pets are accepted and what documents or carriers are needed. Make a backup arrangement with a trusted person.

**Pack basic care**

03

Take normal food, safe water, medicines, waste supplies and a familiar blanket if readily available. Include pet water in the household total.

**Keep identification current**

04

Use a tag and a recent photo, and check microchip contact details before emergencies. Keep veterinary records privately.

**Avoid unsafe rescue**

05

Tell reachable responders where an animal may be, but do not return to fire, floodwater or active danger yourself.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Use a trusted host or verified animal-care arrangement rather than assuming public shelters accept pets. Keep the family and animals together where safe and feasible.

Watch for.

A service animal and a pet may have different accommodation rules. Never leave animals in a hot vehicle while arranging shelter.

People & practical needs.

Assign a trusted adult to each person who needs assistance. Keep medicines, essential contacts and a workable reunion plan with the group

Next decision.

Check animals regularly for overheating, cold and distress in transport. Keep them restrained in crowded temporary accommodation and maintain hygiene.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

[Ready.gov](#) · [Pets and animals](#)

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/pet-evacuation/>